

Adani Group Chairman Mr Gautam Adani offers prayers at the Baba Baidyanath Temple in Deoghar, Jharkhand, on February 22.

POWERING INDIA'S NEXT LEAP: How infrastructure is redrawing the nation's growth map

From ultra-supercritical power plants in Jharkhand and Bihar to a nature-inspired airport terminal in Assam and from defence indigenisation to AI-led governance reforms, the Adani Group's leadership outlines a blueprint where development, culture and credibility converge in service of India's next growth chapter.

On a balmy morning in Deoghar, Jharkhand, on February 22, before boardroom reviews and site inspections, Adani Group Chairman Mr Gautam Adani offered prayers at the revered Baba Baidyanath Temple, fulfilling what he described as a long-held personal wish. The gesture was deeply personal, rooted in faith and in his oft-articulated belief that *Seva hi Sadhana hai*, service itself is a form of devotion. But the day that followed was firmly anchored in strategy.

For over a decade, the Adani Group has increasingly directed capital into industrially underdeveloped parts of India, regions rich in resources but historically bypassed by large private investment. In many of these geographies, few major corporate houses had ventured at scale. Eastern India now stands as one of the clearest expressions of that approach.

In Jharkhand's tribal-dominated Godda district, Mr Adani reviewed operations at the 1,600 MW ultra-supercritical thermal power plant built at an investment of over ₹16,000 crore. Among the largest private-sector commitments in a region long starved of industrial capital, the project has generated thousands of direct and indirect jobs while strengthening rail connectivity. Its power is supplied exclusively to Bangladesh under a long-term agreement, giving the plant cross-border economic significance and reinforcing India's role as a regional energy partner.

Across the border in Bihar, at Pirpainti near Bhagalpur, groundwork continues for a 2,400 MW ultra-supercritical project representing an investment of more than ₹27,000 crore. Expected to be commissioned over the next four to five years, the plant is designed to support rising industrial and urban demand in one of India's most populous states.

Together, these investments position the Group among the largest private infrastructure investors in eastern India. For a corridor rich in mineral resources yet long constrained by limited industrial capital, the projects signal a decisive shift in India's growth geography, with capital flowing eastward to unlock long-neglected potential.

At Godda, the Chairman spent time not only reviewing turbines and transmission systems, but also interacting with engineers, frontline workers and tribal women from neighbouring communities. The visit carried a quiet message—large infrastructure is not merely about megawatts or big numbers, it is about livelihoods, mobility and the steady integration of underserved regions into the national mainstream.

Governance, Indigenisation and Scale

If Mr Adani's eastern India tour underscored execution on the ground, his eldest son Mr Karan Adani's remarks in New